

Shashi Shekhar

Credit Risk Strategy & Decision Science | SMB Lending

s.shashi24@outlook.com | shash-shekhar.com | linkedin.com/in/shashi--shekhar | Bengaluru, India | Open to relocation

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Credit risk strategist with 5+ years in lending, now in Global Credit Risk at PayPal on a multi-billion-dollar US and UK SMB lending book. Design credit policy, default definitions, PD models and account-level economics, and take each through second-line (2LoD), Model Risk Management, Legal and Compliance review into the production decision engine.

SKILLS

Credit strategy and governance: Credit policy and cut-off design, swap-set analysis, risk grading, PD calibration, default definition, champion-challenger testing, pricing and line assignment, Open Banking underwriting, credit risk committee governance, 2LoD and MRM review, vendor model oversight

Portfolio economics and loss: Vintage loss (VLR) and gross credit loss (GCL) analysis, account-level P&L and NPV (CLTV), chain-ladder forecasting, delinquency stress testing, IFRS 9 PD/EAD/LGD, collections early warning

Modelling: Gradient boosting (XGBoost, LightGBM), scorecards, CART, survival analysis (Cox PH), SHAP

Data and tools: Python, SQL, R, PySpark, AWS, Snowflake, Tableau, Power BI

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Data Scientist, Global Credit Risk

PayPal, Bengaluru | Nov 2024 – Present

Credit strategy for a multi-billion-dollar US and UK SMB lending book, accountable to the credit risk committee for early-delinquency and guardrail performance. Every strategy below cleared 2LoD, MRM, Legal and Compliance review.

- Redesigned US post-bureau credit policy on commercial bureau data and recalibrated the PD models behind it. Tested by swap-set analysis against the incumbent strategy, with gross credit loss (GCL) under balance control, then assigned new risk grades. **Eligibility +3 pp** and more loans booked, with **portfolio VLR down 200 bps**.
- Replaced a single early-delinquency default flag with a **multi-horizon default definition** after showing it mislabelled accounts both ways: early delinquents that later cured, and current accounts that deteriorated later. Validated by champion-challenger with PSI monitoring; deployed as the production rule layer for bank-based underwriting, cutting that segment's **VLR by 250 bps**.
- Built a multi-year **account-level P&L (CLTV)** by score band and customer type: chain-ladder loss and behaviour curves carried through fee revenue, credit losses, reserves, funding and acquisition cost to **NPV and ROI per account**, with delinquency stress testing. Sets score-band cut-offs and guides risk-based pricing and acquisition spend.
- Launched **US Open Banking underwriting** for business loans at an **82% straight-through rate**; root-caused data-extraction failures and eliminated them within weeks of launch. Designed the approve/decline credit rules for the **UK Open Banking** business-loan launch.
- Designed the bank-based underwriting decision engine: consolidated redundant legacy rules and combined internal PD models with external bureau scores across bureau, Open Banking and no-document paths, all resolving to pricing and line assignment.
- Run each strategy across its stakeholders: oversee external vendor PD models, align with the internal fraud team, specify rule-engine and process-flow changes for the rules and backend engineering teams, and defend the work with 2LoD, MRM, Legal and Compliance.
- Direct **2 external consultant data scientists** on strategy optimisation and automation.

Senior Manager, Analytics – Risk & Data Science

Liquiloans, Mumbai | Feb 2024 – Oct 2024

- Led a **team of 5** (3 full-time, 2 interns) across scorecards, collections and credit strategy.
- Built application, behaviour and propensity scorecards with gradient boosting and SHAP: **approval rate +10 pp** and **NPA down 50 bps**.
- Built the collections early-warning system, raising **collection efficiency 30%**; developed cross-sell and partnership credit strategies from IFRS 9 PD/EAD/LGD loss forecasting.

Business Analyst – Strategy, Growth & Risk

Jodo, Bengaluru | Oct 2022 – Dec 2023

- Built the company's first in-house credit risk model, from zero: 40% faster underwriting turnaround and a newly identified customer segment. Managed 2 interns.
- Built the AWS data warehouse pipeline (Glue, PySpark), cutting data turnaround 40× and automating 80% of ad-hoc reporting.

Data Analyst – Data Science Consulting

Accelera Eloquent, New Delhi | Jan 2021 – Oct 2022

- Built segmentation and NLP models for retail and eCommerce clients (footfall +30%); a Bayesian A/B testing framework lifted new-product sales 10%.

EDUCATION

B.Tech, Electronics & Communication Engineering

IIIT Guwahati, India | 2019